DETECTIVE ONLY · CASE #1031

# How the evidence adds up

Rule of the Bureau: a clue never says who did it. It says who **didn't**. Each station produces one fact; the squad checks it against the suspects' own statement forms and crosses off whoever doesn't match. Four stations, four suspects, four cross-offs. Whoever is left wasn't on the list.

**1 · Do the station**
Measure, fizz, decode, or wrap. Every kid has a job.

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**2 · Open the clue**
The sealed envelope states the fact in plain words.

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**3 · Check the statements**
Read the four forms on the wall (and the case file table).

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**4 · Cross one off**
Whoever doesn't match is cleared. Write "Clears:" in the log.

| Clue | 🏫 Principal | 📖 Reading Specialist | 📚 Librarian | 🧹 Custodian | 🍎 The Chief not on the list |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 👣 **1 · Evidence Lab**<br>Footprint by the shelf: 26 cm = **size 9**.<br>Who does NOT wear a 9? | ✓<br>size 9 | ✓<br>size 9 | ✗<br>**size 7 · cleared** | ✓<br>size 9 | ✓<br>size 9 |
| 👻 **2 · Ghostbuster Lab**<br>Ghost words: SEEN IN HALL AT **2:15**. Now the time is known.<br>Who was NOT in the building at 2:15? | ✗<br>**off campus 1:00–3:00 · cleared** | ✓<br>reading room, all afternoon | ✓<br>shelving 2:00–2:30 | ✓<br>in the building, all afternoon | ✓<br>classroom, all afternoon |
| 📜 **3 · Cipher Room**<br>Hidden P.S. on the note: "Snagged my **blue sweater** on the shelf."<br>Who did NOT wear blue? | ✓<br>blue sweater | ✓<br>blue, school color | ✓<br>blue cardigan | ✗<br>**gray · cleared** | ✓<br>blue sweater |
| 🧻 **4 · Mummy Witness**<br>The witness: squeezed one, whispered "so satisfying." The thief **loves squishies**.<br>Who does NOT love squishies? | ✓<br>loves them ("just one") | ✗<br>**doesn't get them · cleared** | ✓<br>one on every cart | ✓<br>loves them (records) | ✓<br>"Fine. Love them." |
| **After four clues** | **Cleared by Clue 2** | **Cleared by Clue 4** | **Cleared by Clue 1** | **Cleared by Clue 3** | **Matches all four** |

## 2:28 · How the Chief gets caught

1. A squad says "everyone's crossed off." The Detective: "Then your list is too short. Size 9, in the building at 2:15, blue sweater, loves squishies. Who else was in this building yesterday?"
2. The Detective produces the **fifth statement form**, the Chief's, "filled out for completeness," and pins it to the board.
3. The squad checks it line by line: size 9 ✓, classroom all afternoon ✓, blue sweater ✓, "Don't be ridiculous" crossed out, "Fine. Love them." ✓
4. Warrants name the Chief. Video 4 is her confession, and it tells them where the squishies are: "you'd need a very special light."

## The breadcrumbs (for the kid who asks "how were we supposed to know?")

- The opening: "Chief Mrs. Driscoll has assured me she is not a suspect."
- After Video 1, the Chief's live flinch: "Candy. ...Mostly. Candy-adjacent."
- The Principal's slip: who told *him* they were squishies?
- The Librarian saw someone hugging something "like a puppy," which is exactly what the witness saw.
- The Librarian's whisper: "check their feet."



✓ matches the clue · ✗ doesn't match, cross them off